ASHOKA UNIVERSITY

CENTRE FOR
Climate Change
and Sustainability

# HEALING EARTH WORKSHOP

## Ideas and Conversations on Climate Change & Sustainability



Photo Credit: Dr Dipendra Nath Basu

SEPTEMBER 11 & 12, 2026
ASHOKA UNIVERSITY

**Last date for Registration**
**20th August 2026**

Scan the QR Code to Apply

# WHO WE ARE

The Centre for Climate Change and Sustainability (3CS) at Ashoka University was established in 2019 to bring together members of the Ashoka community who share an interest in studying, communicating, and mitigating the impacts of human-induced climate change. In its first six years, the 3CS has established itself as one of Ashoka University's most vibrant, active, and multidisciplinary centres. The Centre's inaugural flagship event, Healing Earth, held in February 2021 in the immediate aftermath of the COVID-19 pandemic, exemplified this vision. It brought together rigorous academic approaches to understanding climate change and its impacts with broader perspectives on sustainability that emphasize ecological health and resilience.




Advancing interdisciplinary research, innovation, and action on climate change and sustainability at Ashoka University.

# ABOUT HEALING EARTH WORKSHOP SERIES

The Healing Earth workshop series is designed to catalyse action on issues pertaining to climate change and sustainability by advancing policy engagement; building strategic partnerships among policymakers, practitioners, academics, and students; and promoting the adoption of scalable climate solutions. The 3CS plans to host such workshops on a biannual basis.

This inaugural workshop will focus on two keys areas, Science, and Policy & Governance aspects of climate change.

**Workshop 1: The Science of Climate Change**

This workshop will centre on Earth's climate systems with special emphasis on climate science, biodiversity, adaptation, and communication. It will give participants an accessible, research-grounded introduction from leading scholars and practitioners to how the climate has evolved, how human activities are reshaping it, and how different approaches can address the resulting impacts on ecosystems and communities.

**Workshop 2: Policy and Governance in the Age of Climate Change**

This workshop will give participants an accessible introduction by some of the leading policymakers, innovators, and scholars of India on how policy can help us adapt to and mitigate the harmful effects of climate change, and how it can help foster meaningful synergies between government, industry, society, and science.

# CONFERENCE SCHEDULE

## Workshop 1: The Science of Climate Change

**DAY 1 September 11, 2026**

| Time | Title | Speaker |
|---|---|---|
| **10:30 am - 10:45 am** | **Introductory remarks on Climate Change: The Imperative to Act Now Science, Economics, and the Strategic Path Forward for India** | **Prof Shivani Krishna**, Assistant Professor of Biology, Ashoka University, Sonipat<br><br>**Prof Imroze Khan**, Director- 3CS and Associate Professor of Biology, Ashoka University, Sonipat |
| **10:45 am – 11:15 am** | **Tiny Shells, Deep Time: How Marine Carbonates Record Earth's Climate** | **Prof Sambuddha Mishra,** Centre for Earth Sciences, Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore |
| **11:15 am – 11:45 am** | **How Mangroves Lock Away Carbon—and Why It Matters** | **Prof Indra Sekhar Sen,** Department of Earth Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur |
| **11:45 am – 12:15 pm** | **From intuition to technological solutions to environmental problems: Understanding nuance in examples from climate change-motivated restoration and managing wildlife conflict** | **Prof Meghna Agarwala**, Associate Professor of Environmental Studies, Ashoka University, Sonipat |
| **12:15 pm – 2:00 pm** | 🍽 **Brainstorming/Networking Lunch** | |
| **2:00 pm – 2:30 pm** | **Carbon, Commodity, Community: the Science and Practice of Nature-based Solutions** | **Prof Ghazala Shahabuddin,** Visiting Faculty of Environmental Studies, Ashoka University, Sonipat |
| **2:30 pm- 3:00 pm** | **Climate change & Infectious disease Modelling** | **Prof Gautam Menon,** Professor of Physics and Biology, Ashoka University, Sonipat |
| **3:00 pm- 3:30 pm** | **More participation, less AI: Lessons from the CoRE stack - a digital public infrastructure for climate change adaptation of rural communities** | **Prof Aaditeshwar Seth,** Department of Computer Science and Engineering-Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi |
| **3:30 pm – 3:50 pm** | ☕ **Tea and Coffee Break** | |
| **4:00 pm – 6:00 pm** | **Workshop: Can we communicate the climate crisis through Art** | **Argha Manna,** Artist-in-Residence and Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology, Gandhinagar |

# CONFERENCE SCHEDULE

## Workshop 2: Policy and Governance in the Age of Climate Change

**DAY 2 September 12, 2026**

| Time | Title | Speaker |
|---|---|---|
| **10:00 am - 10:15 am** | **Introductory remarks on the Policy and Governance architecture for Climate Policy and Climate Negotiations** | **Prof Gaurav Garg,** Assistant Professor of History, Ashoka University, Sonipat<br><br>**Dr Krishna Gupta**, IAS, State Election Commissioner, West Bengal |
| **10:15 am – 10:45 am** | **State of play on Govt policy on climate generally and negotiations** | **Dr Anshu Bhardwaj**, Programme Director, Energy, Green Transition & Climate Change, NITI Aayog |
| **10:45 am – 11:15 am** | **A reflection on the law and policy of India on addressing climate change through Urban Governance** | **Prof Uday Shankar,** Dean, Rajiv Gandhi School of Intellectual Property Law, Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur |
| **11:15 am – 11:45 am** | **Cities and Climate Change: the shifting dialectics** | **Prof Sumedha Basu,** Assistant Professor, Environmental Studies, Ashoka University, Sonipat |
| **11:45 am – 12:00 pm** | ☕ **Tea and Coffee Break** | |
| **12:00 pm – 12:30 pm** | **Carbon Pricing Pathways for India** | **Prof Shreekant Gupta,** Visiting Senior Fellow at The Centre for Social and Economic Progress (CSEP), New Delhi |
| **12:30 pm- 1:00 pm** | **Scaling Carbon Removal: From India, for the World** | **Sparsh Agarwal,** Co-Founder, Alt Carbon |
| **1:00 pm- 1:30 pm** | **Managing Climate Change from Below: Lessons from Urban India** | **Prof Amita Baviskar,** Professor of Environmental Studies and Sociology and Anthropology, Ashoka University, Sonipat |
| **1:30 pm – 2:30 pm** | 🍽 **Brainstorming/Networking Lunch** | |
| **2:30 pm – 3:30 pm** | **Panel Discussion:** Climate Science and Climate Policy: Solutions and Adaptations | Moderated by **Dr Krishna Gupta, IAS** |

# SPEAKER PROFILES



**Dr Krishna Gupta IAS**
State Election Commissioner, West Bengal



**Dr Anshu Bharadwaj**
NITI Aayog



**Prof Uday Shankar**
Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur



**Prof Gautam Menon**
Ashoka University
Sonipat



**Prof Amita Baviskar**
Ashoka University
Sonipat



**Prof Shreekant Gupta**
The Centre for Social and Economic Progress
New Delhi



**Prof Aaditeshwar Seth**
Indian Institute of Technology Delhi



**Prof Meghna Agarwala**
Ashoka University
Sonipat



**Prof Sambuddha Mishra**
Indian Institute of Science
Bangalore



**Prof Indra Sekhar Sen**
Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur



**Argha Manna**
Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar



**Prof Sumedha Basu**
Ashoka University
Sonipat



**Prof Ghazala Shahabuddin**
Ashoka University
Sonipat



**Sparsh Agarwal**
Co-Founder, Alt Carbon

# WHO CAN APPLY?

Students and working professionals with an interest in the science, policy, and broader implications of climate change and sustainability are encouraged to apply.

**The workshop may be particularly relevant for:**

- Undergraduate and postgraduate students.
- Researchers and educators.
- Journalists and science communicators.
- Policy and development professionals.
- Professionals working in climate change, sustainability or related fields.

Applicants from all academic and professional backgrounds are welcome.

Participation is limited and will be based on the information provided in the application form.

# HOW TO APPLY

Applicants must complete and submit the online application form by 20 August 2026.
Use the application link provided on this page or scan the QR code to access the form.

**Click Here to Apply**

**Application deadline: 20 August 2026**

**Selection notification:** Selected applicants will be informed by 30 August 2026.
For any further queries, please write to us at 3CS@ashoka.edu.in.

Scan the QR Code to Apply

# INFORMATION FOR PARTICIPANTS

- There is no registration fee.
- Lunch will be provided at the venue on both days.
- Shuttle transportation from Azadpur Metro Station to the Ashoka University campus will be available on both days.
- The shuttle schedule, pickup point and other logistical details will be communicated to selected participants.
- Certificates of participation will be awarded to participants who attend the workshop.
- Participants are expected to attend the complete workshop on both days.

# ORGANISING COMMITTEE



**Prof Imroze Khan**

Director, 3CS and Associate Professor of Biology, Ashoka University



**Prof Shivani Krishna**

Assistant Professor of Biology, Faculty Coordinator of Natural Sciences-3CS, Ashoka University



**Prof Gaurav C. Garg**

Assistant Professor of History, Faculty Coordinator of Social Sciences & Policy Research-3CS, Ashoka University



**Rohith Unnikrishnan**

Deputy Manager, 3CS Ashoka University

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